



▲ LOCH NESS is a 23-mile- (37-km-) long lake in Scotland. Despite its size, scientists think there are not enough fish in the lake to support a predator the size of the Loch Ness monster.



Computer generated artwork of the Loch Ness monster.

WHY A PLESIOSAUR?

Pictures such as the surgeon's photograph show a long-necked creature like a plesiosaur. They inspired theories that Loch Ness's hidden depths might harbor creatures that survived from the age of the dinosaurs. But the water is probably too cold for giant reptiles, and Loch Ness was frozen solid during the last ice age.



Plesiosaur fossil

◀ FOSSILIZED PLESIOSAUR SKELETON *Plesiosaurs had long necks and small heads, just like images of the Loch Ness monster. But their necks were probably too weak to raise the head high above the surface.*